A Journey of Dignity, Opportunity and Belonging

From Marginalisation to Mainstream Development



Over the past 78 years of Independence, India has worked towards strengthening its rural economy. Yet, tribal communities, despite being among the country's earliest custodians of forests and natural resources, remained on the margins of development for decades. Their dependence on common natural resources often resulted in limited socio economic gains for the communities themselves. Acknowledging the gap, Ministry of Tribal Affairs (MoTA) has adopted a comprehensive and mission driven approach to ensure that tribal communities become equal partners in India's development journey.

Targeting Comprehensive Tribal Development

In the past 12 years, an integrated approach, underlining the ethos of 'government as one' has been adopted to bring noticeable change in lives of tribals through socio-economic development and promotion of tribal heritage. Various initiatives such as Eklavya Model Residential Schools (EMRS), Pradhan Mantri Janjati Adivasi Nyaya Maha Abhiyan (PM JANMAN), Dharti Aaba Janjatiya Gram Utkarsh Abhiyan (DA JGUA), Tribal Freedom Fighters Museums (TFFMs) and Van Dhan Vikas Kendras (VDVKs) have been instrumental in bringing this transition. These efforts are further supplemented through provisions of grants under Proviso to Article 275 (1) of the Constitution of India which provides for development of scheduled tribes and scheduled areas.

Celebrating Tribal History and Heritage

Addressing the nation from the ramparts of the Red Fort on 15th August, 2016, Prime Minister, Shri Narendra Modi, announced tribal museums dedicated to tribal freedom fighters so that their sacrifices for the country are acknowledged and the nation pays tribute to their memories. Pursuant to the announcement, 11 Tribal Freedom Fighter Museums (TFFM) were sanctioned in 10 states. To further the cause of promoting tribal heritage, Government declared 15th November, the birth date of Bhagwan Birsa Munda as Janjatiya Gaurav Divas in 2021.

Building Paths for Tribal Children

Since its inception in 1999, Ministry has given utmost priority to provide good quality education to tribal students in a safe and conducive environment as education is the biggest social mobiliser. This vision was exemplified in the setting up of Eklavya Model Residential Schools (EMRS) which were initially supported through Art 275 grants but in 2018-19, the entire approach was restructured. EMRS were configured as a Central Sector Scheme with an allocation of more than 24000 crores, as a result of which, school infrastructure, pedagogic equipment and good quality teachers have been ensured. National Education Society for Tribal Students (NESTS), an autonomous organization, has been established to manage and implement the scheme in an effective manner.



Strengthening Tribal Livelihood Opportunities

Van Dhan Vikas Kendras (VDVK) were launched in 2018-19 to target livelihood generation for tribal gatherers and transforming them into entrepreneurs. Then during 2021-22, the scheme was revamped as Pradhan Mantri Janjatiya Vikas Mission (PMJVM) and scope of VDVKs was broadened to include procurement, processing and production of all tribal products, including non-MFP items.

Transformative Missions for Tribal Development

The Ministry is implementing two flagship initiatives, Dharti Aaba Janjatiya Gram Utkarsh Abhiyan (DA JGUA), launched by Hon'ble Prime Minister on 2nd October 2024, and Pradhan Mantri Janjati Adivasi Nyaya Maha Abhiyan (PM JANMAN), launched by Hon'ble Prime Minister on 15th November, 2023, aimed at delivering comprehensive infrastructure and essential services across tribal and Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Group (PVTG) villages through a whole of government approach.

While launching PM JANMAN from Khunti, Jharkhand on the occasion of Janjatiya Gaurav Divas on 15th November, 2023, Prime Minister, Shri Narendra Modi said, "Earlier governments did the work of connecting the figures, but I want to connect the lives, not the figures. With this goal, PM JANMAN has started today". PM JANMAN has been a milestone initiative in addressing development of PVTGs through convergence among 9 Union Ministries / Departments. In many cases scheme norms have been relaxed to reach remote PVTG habitations/ households. Based on the learnings from PM JANMAN, DA JGUA was conceptualized. The Abhiyan converges 17 Union Ministries / Departments through 25 interventions with an aim to saturate infrastructural gaps in around 63000 tribal majority villages.

Reinforcing Livelihoods Through Skills and Tribal Tourism

Alongside welfare initiatives, the Ministry is creating sustainable livelihood opportunities by promoting entrepreneurship, green skills and community based tourism among tribal communities.